Incident report: webhook deliveries failed after a certificate expiry

Document: INC-202

Date: 2026-02-10

Services: notifications

Summary

SEV2 incident: the TLS client certificate used by the notifications service to deliver webhooks expired at 06:00 UTC on February 9, 2026. The expiry was detected at 08:47 UTC. The certificate was renewed at 09:10 UTC. Incident commander: Elena Petrova. The outage lasted 3 hours 10 minutes.

Impact

Webhook deliveries to merchants failed during the outage window. A total of 42,300 webhooks were unable to be delivered while the certificate was expired. After certificate renewal, the notifications service successfully redelivered all failed webhooks to merchants.

Timeline

- 06:00 UTC: TLS client certificate expired
- 08:47 UTC: certificate expiry detected
- 09:10 UTC: certificate renewed
- Webhooks redelivered after renewal

Root cause

The webhook delivery certificate was not renewed before its expiration. The certificate had been valid for 365 days from issuance. Monitoring and alerting for certificate expiry did not prevent this incident.

Resolution

The expired certificate was renewed at 09:10 UTC, restoring the ability of the notifications service to authenticate with merchant endpoints. The notifications service automatically redelivered all 42,300 failed webhooks after certificate renewal completed.

Follow-up actions

- Implement automated certificate renewal procedures per RB-09 (Runbook: rotating notifications TLS certificates)
- Review the status of CHG-1019 (Change CHG-1019: certificate expiry alert for webhook delivery) to ensure alerting is active and effective
- Establish a process to monitor certificate expiry dates and trigger renewal well before expiration
- Refer to STS-102 (Status: delayed webhook notifications) for merchant communication details